



RobotUnion
Grant Agreement N°: **779967**
Start date: **01/01/2018**
Duration: **36 months**

D1.5 RobotUnion Marketplace

WP	WP1
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Dissemination Level	PU
Nature	OT

Dissemination Level:	
PU	Public
PP	Restricted to other programme participants (Including the Commission Services)
RE	Restricted to a group specified by the consortium (Including the Commission Services)
CO	Confidential, only for members of the consortium (Including the Commission Services)

Nature	
PR	Prototype
RE	Report
SP	Specification
TO	Tool
OT	Other

Synopsis	This document describes the Robot Union Marketplace
Keywords	Marketplace, Mentors, Technical Mentors, Business Mentors, Facilities



*Project funded by the Horizon 2020 Framework Programme of the European Union,
Grant agreement N°: **No. 779967***

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DOCUMENT HISTORY

Version	Status ¹	Date	Comments	Author
1	Draft	26/03/2018		Roi Rodríguez (FBOX)
2	Draft	28/03/2018		Iwona Cymerman (FBOX)
3	Under Review	28/03/2018		All
4	Issued	30/03/2018		

¹ Status (a status is associated to each step of the document life cycle)

Draft: This version is under development by one or several partner(s)

Under review: This version has been sent for review

Issued: This version of the document has been submitted to EC

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS AND DEFINITIONS

DoA	Description of Action
EC	European Commission
H2020	Horizon 2020
GA	Grant Agreement
CA	Consortium Agreement
KPI	Key Performance Indicator
CSA	Coordination and Support Action
PMP	Project Management Plan

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1. Introduction

1.1. Introduction

RobotUnion is the pan-European Robotics Acceleration program.

RobotUnion will select 20 startups that **will be financed with up to €223,000 equity free in cash** plus acceleration services. The 20 startups selected will receive €3,800 each in cash equity free and services in the first phase. The 10 best of these startups will enter in the product acceleration program and will receive up to €120,000 in cash equity free. Finally, the 4 best startups will receive up to €100,000, so in total they can receive up to €223,000 equity free in cash plus services.

The four best startups will also have **the possibility to be privately funded with around €1M** with the help of [Blumorpho](#), [Odense Seed and Venture](#) and [Chrysalix](#) that are part of RobotUnion consortium.

Selected companies would be able to participate in a 12 months online **Premium Acceleration Service**, led by top Research and Technology Organizations from all over Europe, key world-class digital ecosystem professionals and entrepreneurs, which will include:

- **State-of-the-art technical support and access to “premier-class” technology** provided by top Research and Technology Organizations like [VTT](#), [DTI](#), [TU DELFT](#), [TECNALIA](#) and [PIAP](#).
- **World-class Training and high level Mentoring** by a pool of tier 1 mentors from Google, Airbnb, Ikea, Yahoo, Prisa, Microsoft, among others, provided by [ISDI](#).
- **Internationalization services**. Presence in top EU Scaleups events such as 4YFN@Mobile World Congress, Slush, Web Summit and International PR exposure powered by [Mobile World Capital](#).
- **Fundraising services** provided by [Blumorpho](#) (private funding) and [FundingBox](#) (public funding).
- **Engagement with world top industry leaders** such as [MADE](#) representing world Manufacturing leaders like Danfoss, Grundfos, Vestas or LEGO among others. [ARLA](#) in Agro Food; [FENIN](#) in Healthcare and [FERROVIAL](#) in Civil Infrastructure.

RobotUnion is looking for startups in the robotics sector. We will prioritize the following verticals: Agrifood, Healthcare, Inspection and maintenance and Manufacturing, there will be a fifth vertical Open Disruptive Innovation to which any project in the Robotics sector could apply

1.2. RobotUnion Marketplace in a nutshell

RobotUnion Marketplace will be the one-stop shop to support Robotics Scaleups in the markets addressed by the project and widely disseminate the products created within the project. **The final objective of the marketplace is supporting the creation of a RobotUnion Community.** A Community around robotics formed by partners and their networks, applicants to the RobotUnion open call, business mentors, technical mentors and Research and Technology Organizations, among others.

The **marketplace** will include:

- Technical and business services offered to the Scaleups.

- The products of the companies accelerated by RobotUnion accelerator.
- Questionnaires to validate the service suppliers, to help the companies navigate through the platform, to help companies and access to the open calls to select the RobotUnion beneficiaries.
- Communication tools to facilitate the interaction among the different actors in the community.

All this will be accessible from spaces.fundingbox.com/c/robotunion.

The marketplace will be set up using FundingBox platform and existing features and it will be populated with partners' services and external suppliers' services that will be previously validated.

2. Marketplace Design

The Marketplace will gather all the information and services to be offered to RobotUnion stakeholders, becoming a single point of entry and to know-how services of technical and non-technical nature.

The main features of the marketplace are:

- Technical and business services offered to the Scaleups.
 - **Technical Services** including:
 - **Experimentation Facilities Catalogue** offered by partners and 'Validated Services Suppliers', including a repository of advanced Technologies for Robotics.
 - **The pool of Researchers in Residence** or Technical Mentors that will help the Scaleups both from partners and external providers.
 - **Business and training services** including:
 - All the information about the Business services offered by partners including access to online courses, face to face training materials and funding services.
 - The pool of high-level mentors validated as business services providers.
- **Products of the companies accelerated by RobotUnion** accelerator.
- **Open Calls and questionnaires:**
 - **'RobotUnion Self-questionnaire'** which will allow Scaleups to know up-front the services offered through the Marketplace which can fit their needs.
 - **'RobotUnion Validation service'** that will be articulated through two open calls one to validate external technical suppliers and the other one for external business suppliers.
 - **'Investment Diagnostic'** a self-questionnaire service that will allow the Scaleups to know up-front the investment needed to implement their project. It will be also complemented with a direct help-desk support, offered by Blumporpho as partner leading the private investment.
 - **'Funding Readiness Services'** a self-wizard service to guide Scaleups in identifying the public funding sources available at EU level to implement their technical projects. Complementated also with a direct help-desk support, offered by FundingBox as partner leading the Public Funding support.
 - Direct access to the **'Open Calls'** to apply to be part of RobotUnion.
- **Communication tools to facilitate the interaction** among the different actors in the

community.

- Effective **centralized register and management** of end-users (Scaleups) and suppliers (Services' Providers).
- **'Brokerage'** or 'Matchmaking' tool to facilitate brokerage between users and suppliers.
- **Working Spaces**, a real-time communication tool, which provides the features for organising and managing private or public real-time communications, in whatever page/section of the Marketplace, at private or public level.

3. Marketplace Setup

The marketplace has been implemented using the functionalities already existing in the **FundingBox platform**². The platform has two main layers:

- **Spaces**: It provides the display for the services' portfolio within the Marketplace. The content is composed of sections and collections. It also provides real-time communications (a Slack type of functionality). It allows embedding - public or private - chats in whatever page/section of the Marketplace. These chats can be used as help desks, forums, live chats, or working spaces for teams.
- **Gear**: this layer provides the features for launching the Open Calls or the validation of 'Technical & Facilities & Business services' suppliers', among others. It also allows tracking every single event (click) that happens within the Marketplace; this functionality gives us the possibility to offer additional functions such as dashboard; customer engagement analytics; communication and management strategy.

[RobotUnion Community and Marketplace](#) developed under the Spaces layer of FundingBox can be seen below of Figure 1:

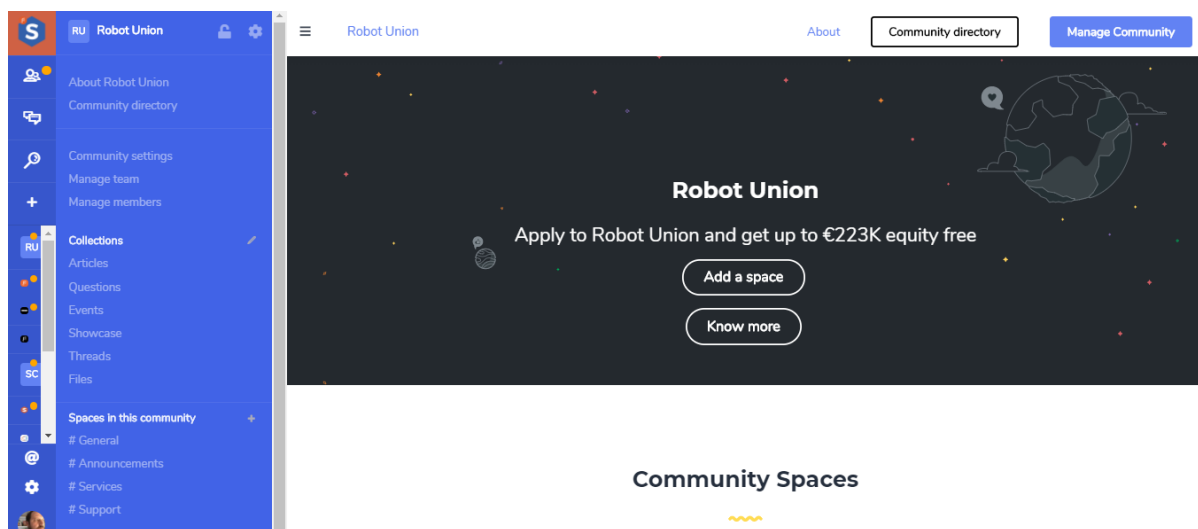


Figure 1. Screenshot of the Marketplace in FundingBox

² **Funding Box Platform** is a comprehensive set of tools to build and grow communities. The Platform is based on three main products: Discover, Spaces and Gear. The platform functionalities are described in <https://platform.fundingbox.com/>. Customization will be required to meet the project needs, but additional developments should not be needed

In the left bar there is access to all the features of the Marketplace that is designed with the aim of creating a community around RobotUnion.

- The first section includes:
 - About RobotUnion, a landing page where it is explained the aim of the project and the community and marketplace.
 - Community directory, a list of all the people in the community.
- The second section includes several links to manage the community:
 - Community settings. You can change the url, the tagline and the description.
 - Manage team. To manage the team members, those who have access to the backend to manage the site.
 - Manage members. To manage the community members, you also can chat directly with each of the members of the community.
- The third section is 'collections' where are included the main contents of the site:
 - Announcements will include the open calls and the questionnaires of RobotUnion: open call for Scaleups, open call for validating technical suppliers, open call for validating business suppliers, private and public funding questionnaires, among others.
 - Events will include the main events of RobotUnion and of the robotics sector: the open calls of RobotUnion and other robotics projects, the info sessions delivered by the consortium to present the project, the main events in Robotics among others.
 - The showcase will include the description and profiles of the following services:
 - Technical mentors.
 - Business mentors.
 - Training courses.
 - Facilities.
 - Products of the Scaleups.
 - Funding Services provided by the partners of the consortium.
 - Articles will include a list of the articles sent by the community to the different Spaces.
 - Questions will include a list of questions sent by the community to the different Spaces.
- Finally the fourth section includes the Spaces, the channels where the community can interact, from scratch we will have Seven Spaces:
 - Announcements. A place to share all the relevant events with the community.
 - General. Space to introduce the new members of the community, to include interesting information for the community, etc.
 - Support. A helpdesk to help the community with the doubts they can have regarding the open call
 - Technical Services. Space to introduce the technical service suppliers and their offers, both facilities and Technical Mentors.
 - Business Services. Space to introduce the business mentors, the training courses and the funding services provided by the partners of the consortium.
 - Products. Space to showcase the products of the Scaleups accelerated by RobotUnion.

4. Marketplace Population

A twofold approach will be followed to populate the marketplace:

- 1) **Partners' services and existing suppliers will be included in the marketplace.**
 - a. The Research and Technology Organizations will include their facilities and their mentors, the ones that will act as Researchers in Residence.
 - b. Business partners will include in the marketplace their mentors, part of whom will be internal and part external. The external ones will be people that have already worked with partners in other acceleration programs like [IMPACT Accelerator](#).
- 2) **Validation of external new services:**
 - a. Two open calls will be launched to select technical mentors and facilities and business mentors. The goal of these calls is to complement the existing offer provided by partners. This validation will be done according to the procedure indicated in *D.1.6. Validation Service of Technology Services*.
 - b. Once the suppliers are validated, they will be included in the marketplace.

The Open Calls will be disseminated through all the channels included in deliverable *D.1.1. Communication and Dissemination Plan* and will be used as a claim to foster the collaboration with other initiatives as indicated in deliverable *D.1.3. Liaising Strategy*. This will be done by offering other initiatives to be part of the marketplace showcasing their services in it.

Once the Marketplace is running, a Growth Hacking Strategy will be launched to attract and retain the maximum number of stakeholders into the Marketplace. The goal is to convert the deal flow of applicants to the suppliers open call and to the acceleration program open call in an active and vibrant community.

The 'Robotics Onboarding Service' will be the main entry-point to the marketplace and, through an on-boarding service, will guide Scaleups to the different services offered.

The RiR and the Business and Fundraising mentors will become the main evangelist of this marketplace by using it to support the Scaleups.

5. Status and next steps

The marketplace has been defined and a first version has been set up. Before the end of April 2018 it will be tested by populating it with partners' services. Once the test is finished the open calls for technical and business services will be launched. Every month there will be an analysis of the applications received to populate the marketplace.

Regarding the questionnaires to include in the marketplace, they will be uploaded as soon as the open calls are ready to be launched. The open call will be linked on April 16th 2018, the open calls to validate service suppliers in early-May 2018 once the marketplace was tested and together with the onboarding services for startups. Finally the funding readiness services questionnaires will be included in 2019.

6. Marketplace Exploitation and Sustainability

The marketplace will be one of the cornerstones through which RobotUnion will leverage the sustainability of the project.

The marketplace, which will integrate the Robotics solutions developed during the project, will become a kind of place of reference for Robotics Scaleups. 20,000 visitors are expected during the duration of the project.

The following table gives a general overview of the exploitation plan that we foresee for the marketplace:

Result: RobotUnion Marketplace			
Uses	Users	Channels	Impact
· Innovation · Access to technologies · Commercial · Investment · Access to Funding · Business Growth · Matchmaking · Community building · Entrepreneurial Discovery	· Robotics end-users · Robotics suppliers · Digital Innovation Hubs · Competence Centres/RTOs	· International Events · Media (Storytelling) · EuRobotics · Consortium networks · Growth Hacking · Industrial Advisory Committee · Investors Advisory Committee · Regional Advisory Committee	· N° users · Geo-coverage of users · Matchmaking between Robotics suppliers & users · Private funding mobilized · Awareness of experiences and best practices

Table 1. First approach of the exploitation plan of the marketplace

A more detailed approach will be included in the *D.6.1 Plan for the Exploitation and Dissemination of Results*.